

Fabio Carrella

Postdoctoral Researcher

Recod.ai Lab, Institute of Computing, University of Campinas

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Research Experience

Postdoctoral Researcher

2025–present

Institute of Computing, University of Campinas

Campinas, Brazil

- Researcher on the Horus project (FAPESP), investigating AI-mediated communication and synthetic realities in online environments (Prof. Anderson Rocha).
- Researcher on the Aletheia project (CNPq), investigating health-related misinformation in online environments (Prof. Anderson Rocha).

Senior Research Associate

2022–2025

School of Psychological Science, University of Bristol

Bristol, United Kingdom

- Researcher on the Reclaiming Individual Autonomy and Democratic Discourse Online (RAO) project, investigating online information environments, democratic discourse, and psychological microtargeting (Prof. Stephan Lewandowsky).
- Researcher on the Honesty Project, using computational analysis of large-scale text corpora to investigate how political honesty is understood and evaluated (Prof. Stephan Lewandowsky).

Education

PhD in Linguistics and Philological Sciences

2016–2020

University for Foreigners of Perugia

Perugia, Italy

Postgraduate Certificate in Education (Modern Languages)

2015–2016

University of Portsmouth

Portsmouth, United Kingdom

Master's Degree in Modern Languages and Literature

2011–2013

University of Salerno

Salerno, Italy

Bachelor's Degree in Foreign Languages and Cultures

2008–2011

University of Salerno

Salerno, Italy

Research Interests

Misinformation and political discourse; language and cognition; online communication and digital media; computational approaches to language and communication; artificial intelligence and large language models.

Grants & Funding

Collaborator

2024–2026

Aletheia: Técnicas de Inteligência Artificial, Linguística Computacional e Ciências Sociais para Gestão de Infodemias

Conselho Nacional de Desenvolvimento Científico e Tecnológico, R\$998,500 • Coordinator: Anderson Rocha.

Publications

Aroyehun, S. T., Simchon, A., **Carrella, F.**, Lasser, J., Lewandowsky, S., & Garcia, D. (2025). Computational analysis of US congressional speeches reveals a shift from evidence to intuition. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 9, 1122–1133.

Carrella, F., & Miani, A. (2025). GERMA: a comprehensive corpus of untrustworthy German news. *Linguistics*

- Carrella, F.**, Aroyehun, S. T., Lasser, J., Simchon, A., Garcia, D., & Lewandowsky, S. (2025). Different honesty conceptions align across US politicians' tweets and public replies. *Nature Communications*, 16, 1409.
- Carrella, F.**, Simchon, A., Edwards, M., & Lewandowsky, S. (2025). Warning people that they are being microtargeted fails to eliminate persuasive advantage. *Communications Psychology*, 3, 15.
- Lewandowsky, S., Garcia, D., Simchon, A., & **Carrella, F.** (2024). When liars are considered honest. *Trends in Cognitive Sciences*.
- Lasser, J., Aroyehun, S. T., **Carrella, F.**, Simchon, A., Garcia, D., & Lewandowsky, S. (2023). From alternative conceptions of honesty to alternative facts in communications by US politicians. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 7(12), 2140–2151.
- Carrella, F.**, Miani, A., & Lewandowsky, S. (2023). IRMA: the 335-million-word Italian coRpus for studying MisinformAtion. In *Proceedings of the 17th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 2331–2341.
- Lasser, J., Aroyehun, S. T., **Carrella, F.**, Simchon, A., Garcia, D., & Lewandowsky, S. (2022). Social media sharing of low-quality news sources by political elites. *PNAS Nexus*, 1.
- Carrella, F.** (2020). #Populism on Twitter: Statistical Analysis of the Correlation between Tweet Popularity and “Populist” Discursive Features. *Brno Studies in English*, 46(2), 5–23.
- Carrella, F.** (2019). Frank Underwood vs. Barack Obama: Realism and Fiction in House of Cards Political Speeches. In *Seriality Across Narrations, Languages and Mass Consumption: To Be Continued*, 44–62.
- Carrella, F.** (2018). Analysis of the Correlation Between Populist Discourse and Tweet Popularity. *Colloquium: New Philologies*, 3(2), 27–50.
- Carrella, F.** (2017). Tweets Across the Borders: An Interlingual Study on European Populism. *I-Land Journal*, 2, 121–145.

Working Papers

- Carrella, F.**, & Rocha, A. (2026). Testing Community-Level Interventions in Online Echo Chambers Using LLM Agents. (*under review*).
- Cardenuto, J. P., Monari, A. C., **Carrella, F.**, Diniz Lopes, M., Lusquino Filho, L., & Rocha, A. (2026). Brazilian Social Media Anti-vaccine Information Disorder Dataset (*in preparation*).
- Saalet, P., Aroyehun, S. T., **Carrella, F.**, Abels, C. M., Lewandowsky, S., & Garcia, D. (2026). German parties shifted towards intuition-based rhetoric after the far right's parliamentary breakthrough. (*under review*).

Teaching

Course

Advanced Topics in Computer Science I

2026

Institute of Computing, University of Campinas

M.Sc./Ph.D. course taught in English, covering NLP methods for persuasion and misinformation analysis, semantic representations, topic modelling, and LLM-based discourse analysis.

Supervision

Name	Degree	Year	Co-supervisor
Kai Benjamin	BSc Dissertation	2024	Stephan Lewandowsky
Anna Hardy	BSc Dissertation	2024	Stephan Lewandowsky
Ruby Brightwell	BSc Dissertation	2023	Stephan Lewandowsky
Ali Taha	BSc Dissertation	2023	Stephan Lewandowsky

Invited Talks

- 2026 **VigIA: Monitoring the use of artificial intelligence during electoral campaigns.** Fundação Armando Alvares Penteado (FAAP), São Paulo, Brazil.
- 2024 **When Liars Are Considered Honest: Understanding Different Logics of Political Honesty.** Fundação Getulio Vargas ECMI, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.

2022 **Populism and Social Media: A Study of European Populist Parties' Language on Twitter and Facebook.** Department of English Linguistics, University of Würzburg, Würzburg, Germany.

Conference Presentations

2026 **Testing community-level interventions in online echo chambers using LLM agents.** [Conference Presentation]. ICAME47, Koblenz, Germany.

2025 **Transparency is not enough: Warning people that they are being microtargeted fails to eliminate persuasive advantage.** [Conference Presentation]. Cambridge Disinformation Summit, University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK.

2024 **The effects of warning pop-ups in countering psychological microtargeting.** [Conference Presentation]. IC2S2 2024, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, US.

2024 **The effects of warning pop-ups in countering psychological microtargeting.** [Conference Presentation]. Meeting the Challenges of the Online Information Environment, Max Planck Institute for Human Development, Berlin, Germany.

2024 **The effects of warning pop-ups in countering psychological microtargeting.** [Conference Presentation]. ASIC 2024, Molveno, Italy.

2023 **The “truth contagion” effect in the U.S. political debate.** [Conference Presentation]. ASIC 2023, Kranjska Gora, Slovenia.

2023 **IRMA: the 335-million-word Italian coRpus for studying MisinformAtion.** [Poster Presentation]. EACL, Dubrovnik, Croatia.

2023 **The “truth contagion” effect in the U.S. political debate.** [Conference Presentation]. Oxford Internet Policy & Politics Hybrid Conference, Oxford, UK.

2022 **User Disagreement in the U.S. Political Debate: An Exploration of Truth-Seeking and Belief-Speaking Texts on Twitter.** [Poster Presentation]. Psychonomic Society, Boston, US.

2019 **Sharing Populism: The Effects of Populist Style on Facebook Users Interactions.** [Conference Presentation]. ADDA 2 – Approaches to Digital Discourse Analysis, University of Turku, Finland.

2018 **The Effects of “Populist” Style on Tweet Popularity.** [Conference Presentation]. CMC and Social Media Corpora 2018, University of Antwerp, Belgium.

2018 **Like, Share, Hate: Interpreting Users' Reactions to Populist Aggressive Discourse on Facebook.** [Conference Presentation]. Language of Cyberbullying, ESSE 2018, Masaryk University, Brno, Czech Republic.

2017 **Twitting for the People: An Analysis of Evaluative Language in Populist Tweets.** [Conference Presentation]. Populism and Language, University of Alpen-Adria, Klagenfurt, Austria.

Academic Service

Editorial Board Member (External Editor) Communications Psychology (Nature Portfolio)	2025–present
Website and Talks Coordinator TedCog Lab, University of Bristol	2022–2024
Ad-hoc Reviewer	
PLOS ONE • Applied Cognitive Psychology • Information, Communication & Society • PNAS Nexus • Data in Brief • Lingua • Psychology of Language and Communication.	

Additional Training

Research Methods Summer School: An Introduction to Bayesian Mixed-Effects Models **2024**
University of Reading Online

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS-Edinburgh) **2023**
University of Edinburgh Edinburgh, United Kingdom

Earlier Research Experience

Research Assistant **2012–2013**
Department of Linguistics, University of Salerno Salerno, Italy

Skills

Computer Skills R, Python, L^AT_EX, Qualtrics

Languages Italian (native), English (fluent), Portuguese (good), French (basic), Russian (basic)